RITESH NAIK

AI Product Manager | Enterprise AI & Automation | HRTech
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National Recognition: National Award: PLUTO won the Indian Staffing Federation's Staffing Excellence Recognition 2026 for Outstanding Initiative — one of 18 initiatives recognised across ISF's 120+ member companies; awarded on stage at ISF's 18th National Employment Conference, New Delhi (Aug 2026), and featured in ISF's "Recognising Initiatives of the Staffing Industry" book.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI Product Manager with 11 years across engineering, entrepreneurship, and product — nearly 7 of them in product, including ~3 as a founder. Four years building and owning 5 production AI products in HRTech — from RAG-based assistants and resume evaluators to a voice-screening bot and an internal ATS — deployed to 150+ users with measurable gains in speed (80–90%), quality (shortlist rate +40%), and cost efficiency. Builds hands-on: with no dedicated engineering team, prototypes and ships production AI personally (Python, LLM APIs, RAG). Former founder (PocketTrucks — seed-funded logistics marketplace, 190+ drivers; owned roadmap and specs with an outsourced dev team). Winner of the Indian Staffing Federation's Staffing Excellence Recognition 2026 (Outstanding Initiative) for PLUTO — one of 18 initiatives recognised across ISF's 120+ member companies.

CORE SKILLS

AI / ML: Generative AI, RAG Architectures, LLMs (Gemini, Groq, GPT), Pinecone, Prompt Engineering, LangChain, HuggingFace, Multi-Agent Systems

Product: AI Product Strategy, OKRs, Roadmapping, Discovery, Prioritisation (RICE/ICE), Agile/Sprint Planning, 0→1 & Scaling

Technical: Python, SQL, REST APIs, Flask, Make.com (Integromat), VAPI, Cursor, VSCode, Git, Postman

Platforms: Oorwin, Ceipal, Zoho CRM/Analytics, Google Analytics, Power BI, Looker Studio, Naukri, ATS/CRM integrations

Leadership: IT function ownership (direct report), cross-functional leadership across marketing & operations, stakeholder management, GTM, Enterprise SaaS

EXPERIENCE

Product Manager – AI & Automation | **PeopleLogic Business Solutions** | *Oct 2022 – Present*

Own discovery, roadmap, specs and delivery for the AI product portfolio — 5 production products used daily by 150+ users across India and global teams. The IT function reports to me; marketing and operations partner cross-functionally. No dedicated engineering team — I prototype, build and ship these products hands-on.

- PLUTO AI Recruit Suite — built an end-to-end AI recruiter toolkit (JD Handbook Generator + Resume Evaluator + Voice Bot) that compressed JD analysis from 15–20 min to under 2 min, resume evaluation from 5–10 min to under 2 min, and lifted client shortlist rate from 50% to 70%; cost per evaluation optimised from ₹4 to ₹0.57 (85% reduction) at 30,000 evaluations/month.
- PLUTO won the Indian Staffing Federation's Staffing Excellence Recognition 2026 (Outstanding Initiative) — one of 18 initiatives recognised across ISF's 120+ member companies; profiled as Initiative No. 10 in ISF's "Recognising Initiatives of the Staffing Industry" publication.
- HR RAG Bot — enterprise HR policy assistant on Groq + Pinecone (hybrid BM25 + vector search) that cut policy lookup time by 90% and achieved 95% user satisfaction across 50+ policy documents.
- VAPI Voice Bot — piloted AI call screening for L1 interviews, offloading 25% of recruiter screening workload and capturing structured candidate data for model retraining.
- SpringBoard Analytics Platform — API-integrated dashboard connecting ATS (Oorwin/Ceipal), job portals (Naukri), and call systems (VoxPro); eliminated 80% of manual monthly reporting overhead and delivered real-time KPI visibility organisation-wide.
- IRIS — built a ground-up internal ATS to manage PeopleLogic's own hiring pipeline, reducing dependency on external tools and standardising internal recruitment workflows.
- Recruitment Infrastructure — migrated 150+ users from Excel to enterprise ATS/CRM (Oorwin, Ceipal, Zoho); designed system architecture, configured automations, integrated portals, and built unified analytics via Make.com and Zoho Analytics (Deluge scripting); increased recruiter productivity by 30% and reduced lead-to-hire cycle time by 20%.

Business Development Specialist | **Open Financial Technologies** | *Nov 2020 – Sep 2022*

- Product-facing commercial role: partnered with the Product and Data teams, converting enterprise customer feedback into prioritised product improvements.
- Identified critical UX friction points in onboarding; product team implemented streamlined signup flow based on findings.

- Delivered competitive intelligence and pricing recommendations (feature tiering) to improve conversion and upsell rates.
- Ran product demos and built enablement material for enterprise rollouts.

Co-Founder & Product Owner | **PocketTrucks Services Pvt Ltd** | *Feb 2018 – Oct 2020*

- Built and launched India's first real-time truck booking marketplace from 0→1; onboarded 190+ drivers within 60 days and secured ₹10L seed funding.
- Specified real-time booking and dispatch automation via REST APIs, replacing manual phone-based dispatch.
- Owned the product roadmap, specs and feature logic with an outsourced development team; ran the driver and shipper feedback loop directly.

Procurement Engineer | **LKQ India Pvt Ltd** | *Jul 2016 – Jan 2018*

- Priced salvage vehicles for Keystone's US operations from photo-based damage assessment, cross-referencing VIN history, repair records and engine specs across multiple external sources. Specified the data-aggregation requirements for an internal tool that auto-populated this information on the assessment page, cutting job completion time by 50%.

Graduate Apprentice Trainee | **Volvo Buses India Pvt Ltd** | *Dec 2014 – Nov 2015*

- Contributed to new product development for BRT and SLF bus prototypes for the Indian market.

FLAGSHIP PROJECTS

- **PLUTO AI Recruit Suite** — *Lead Product Manager — Discovery to Production*
  - JD Handbook Generator: transforms any JD into boolean strings, ideal candidate profiles, interview questions, and hiring strategy in under 2 min (down from 15–20 min).
  - Resume Evaluator: LLM-powered scoring with explainability, job-hopping analysis, skills gap, and recommendation — under 2 min per eval, 85% cost reduction (₹4→₹0.57), 70% shortlist rate.
  - Voice Screening Bot (VAPI): AI-led L1 interviews offloading 25% of manual screening; structured outputs fed back as model retraining signals.
- **HR RAG Bot** — *Lead PM — Architecture & Launch*
  - Enterprise HR policy assistant using hybrid search (BM25 + vector) over Pinecone + Groq; 90% lookup time reduction, 95% CSAT, 50+ documents indexed.
- **SpringBoard Analytics Platform** — *Product Owner — E2E*
  - API-driven internal analytics platform integrating ATS, job portals, and call systems; eliminated 80% of manual reporting overhead; adopted organisation-wide.
- **IRIS — Internal ATS** — *Product Owner — 0→1*
  - Custom internal applicant tracking system built from scratch to manage PeopleLogic's own hiring pipeline; eliminated reliance on external ATS for internal roles.
- **PocketTrucks Marketplace** — *Co-Founder & Product Owner*
  - 0→1 logistics marketplace with real-time bidding, live tracking, and trust-based feedback loops; 190+ drivers and 50+ shippers onboarded in 60 days, ₹10L seed funding.

TECHNICAL TOOLBOX

Languages: Python, SQL

AI / ML: Groq (Qwen 3 32B), Gemini 2.5 Flash, GPT-4, Pinecone, HuggingFace, LangChain, RAG pipelines, Prompt Engineering, AI agents (Hugging Face AI Agents Fundamentals, certified)

Platforms: Oorwin, Ceipal, Zoho CRM, Make (Integromat), VAPI, Google Analytics, Google Colab

Tools: Cursor, VSCode, Git, Postman, Antigravity

Practices: Agile, OKRs, ICE/RICE prioritisation, AARRR funnel, A/B testing, Sprint Planning, Backlog Grooming

RECOGNITION & IMPACT

★ PLUTO won the Indian Staffing Federation's Staffing Excellence Recognition 2026 — Outstanding Initiative; one of 18 initiatives recognised across ISF's 120+ member companies, awarded on stage at ISF's 18th National Employment Conference, New Delhi (Aug 2026), and profiled in ISF's “Recognising Initiatives of the Staffing Industry” book.

★ Scaled AI productivity suite across 150+ recruiters — shortlist quality +40% (50%→70%), JD analysis time −90%, eval cost −85%.

★ Voice bot pilot offloaded 25% of recruiter screening workload; HR RAG Bot achieved 95% user satisfaction at enterprise scale.

★ Hugging Face — AI Agents Fundamentals, certified (March 2026).

EDUCATION

B.E (Bachelor of Engineering) — Mechanical Engineering | MITK | 2010–2014